

ATS Candidate-to-Job Match Report

Deepak Arora | Principal Software Development Engineer - Zscaler, San Jose

76	STRONG, WITH MATERIAL SCREENING GAPS
ATS match out of 100	The resume strongly matches Linux kernel, network datapath, systems architecture, troubleshooting, AI/GPU, cloud, and principal-level leadership. It does not explicitly demonstrate several hard JD terms: Go, stateful firewalls, BGP/OSPF/PIM, VLAN/DHCP/SSL/DTLS/QUIC/IPsec/GRE/WireGuard, FIPS/FedRAMP/Common Criteria/SOC 2.

Executive verdict

Overall rank: strong secondary-tier candidate as written; likely interview-worthy under a human technical review, but not a reliable top-three ATS result if the recruiter applies strict minimum-qualification filters.

Human-review fit: 84/100. **Literal ATS fit:** 76/100. **Estimated shortlist probability:** 35-50% as written, rising materially if the missing technologies are genuine and added with evidence. This is an informed estimate, not a prediction of Zscaler's proprietary screening process.

Primary positioning: Deepak reads as a principal systems/platform architect with unusually strong low-level networking, fleet-scale reliability, architecture ownership, GPU infrastructure, and AI operationalization. The role, however, is written for a hands-on cloud-security networking engineer with an explicit Go and protocol/security stack.

Scoring model

Dimension	Weight	Score	Assessment
Experience and education	10	9	20+ years; related master's degree. Degree title is not Computer Science, but is closely related.
Kernel networking and datapath	24	17	Linux modules, drivers, L2/L3, NAT, DPDK, offload, TCP/IP/IPv6, routing throughput. Several named protocols absent.
Programming and debugging	12	7	Python plus deep C/C++/kernel debugging; no Go evidence, which is an explicit minimum.
System design, scale, resilience	12	11	Strong architecture specs, 4M+ fleet, performance design, field root cause, build-vs-buy/TCO.
Security and compliance	12	7	Zero trust, secure boot, hardening, SAST/DAST, pen testing; federal/cloud certifications absent.
AI/ML relevance	10	10	Production AI pipelines, embeddings, agents, governance, GPU work; exceeds foundational requirement.
Cloud, containers, virtualization	8	7	AWS/Azure/GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, MEC and Android containers; direct security virtualization detail is light.
Leadership and collaboration	8	7	25+ cross-functional teams, 10-person team, mentoring and architecture reviews; customer/PRD interaction is less explicit.
Resume ATS mechanics	4	1	Readable two-page PDF, but untagged and uses multi-column-like scope blocks; exact JD vocabulary coverage is incomplete.
TOTAL	100	76	Strong adjacent fit; hard-keyword gaps materially constrain automated ranking.

Requirement-by-requirement match matrix

JD requirement	Status	Resume evidence	ATS interpretation
10+ years high-performance networking	Strong	20+ years; Linux/kernel, routing, Cavium offload, DPDK/SmartNIC analysis	Direct, credible match
Linux kernel networking, L2/L3	Strong	Kernel modules, network drivers, TCP/IP/IPv6, L3 routing/NAT, PHY/MAC	Direct match
Stateful firewalls	Gap	Security architecture and endpoint security, but no stateful firewall implementation stated	Likely treated as missing
BGP, OSPF, PIM	Gap	L3 routing is stated; named routing protocols are not	Broad experience will not guarantee exact-keyword credit
VLAN, DHCP, DNS	Partial	DNS caching is explicit; VLAN and DHCP absent	One of three named protocols matched
SSL/TLS, DTLS, QUIC	Gap/partial	Zero trust and security architecture; TLS-family protocols not listed	Low literal match
IPsec, GRE, WireGuard, L2VPN	Gap	No explicit tunneling/VPN technologies	Preferred/minimum vocabulary absent
Network drivers and datapath debugging	Strong	Drivers, DPDK, packet offload, Wireshark, fleet failure root cause	Excellent transferable evidence
Go and Python	Partial	Python explicit; Go absent; C/C++ strength does not satisfy literal Go requirement	Potential knockout if Go is enforced
AI/ML foundation and application	Strong	Whisper/LLM, RAG, embeddings, LangGraph, GPU similarity, governance	Exceeds requirement
Design/functional specs; testing automation	Strong/partial	Production specs and QA automation explicit; unit testing phrase absent	Good human match; moderate keyword match
Scalable, resilient systems	Strong	4M+ device fleet, high-throughput DVR, systemic reliability, production marketplace	Direct evidence
FIPS/FedRAMP/Common Criteria/SOC 2	Gap	FCC/UL/Wi-Fi/Bluetooth/Energy Star compliance, but not security certifications	Adjacent certification ownership, not equivalent
AWS/Azure; Docker/Kubernetes	Strong	All four appear in skills	Direct preferred match
Mentoring and cross-functional work	Strong	Led/developed 10-person team; led 25+ HW/FW/SW teams; architecture reviews	Direct match

Keyword coverage audit

Coverage tier	Keywords / concepts	Assessment
Directly present	Linux kernel, L2/L3 routing, NAT, network drivers, DNS, TCP/IP, IPv6, Python, AI/ML, Zero Trust, AWS, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, virtualization/containerization, troubleshooting, design specifications, automation, cross-functional leadership	High-confidence ATS hits
Conceptual / adjacent	Stateful firewall, scalable and resilient services, customer use cases, unit testing, predictive threat detection, multitenant cloud security	Relevant evidence exists, but exact wording or direct implementation is missing
Absent and important	Go, BGP, OSPF, PIM, VLAN, DHCP, SSL/TLS, DTLS, QUIC, IPsec, GRE, WireGuard, L2VPN, VRRP, FIPS, FedRAMP, Common Criteria, SOC 2	Do not add unless actually used; several may drive filtering

Top strengths driving the score

- **Principal-level scope:** architecture authority, technology roadmaps, build-vs-buy/TCO, specifications, and leadership across 25+ teams align well with the role's level.
- **Low-level networking credibility:** kernel modules, drivers, packet processing, L3 routing/NAT, DPDK and SmartNIC/DPU analysis provide strong evidence for complex datapath work.
- **Production scale and troubleshooting:** 4M+ devices, systemic field failure analysis, 24-stream storage datapath, and hardware/GPU diagnostics support the performance and resilience mandate.
- **AI-forward profile:** practical AI pipelines, GPU infrastructure, embeddings, multi-agent systems, observability, and governance are unusually strong relative to the JD's foundational AI requirement.
- **Security-adjacent architecture:** zero trust, secure boot, chain of trust, TEE, hardening, SAST/DAST, penetration testing, and endpoint security create a credible bridge into Zscaler's mission.

Highest-impact gaps and risks

Priorit y	Gap	Impact	Recommended response
Critical	Go is absent	Explicit minimum qualification; could be a binary screen	If genuine, add a project/bullet showing production Go. Otherwise do not claim it; use referral context to overcome the screen.
Critical	Named routing/security protocols absent	JD is unusually keyword-specific	Add only protocols personally implemented or debugged, with scope and outcome. Do not keyword-stuff unsupported tools.
High	Federal/cloud security certifications absent	Role explicitly owns FIPS/FedRAMP/Common Criteria/SOC 2 compliance	Position existing certification program ownership as transferable; state any real exposure to crypto validation or security controls.
Medium	Hands-on development appears secondary to architecture	Title is Software Development Engineer	Strengthen recent code ownership, code reviews, tests, debugging, profiling, and shipped components.
Medium	Customer/PM/PRD collaboration not explicit	Role stresses customer use cases and PRD review	Add a concise bullet describing requirements translation across Product, customers, architects, and engineering if accurate.
Medium	PDF is not tagged	Some parsers/accessibility systems prefer tagged structure	Use a clean DOCX application version or a properly tagged, single-column PDF.

Recommended resume changes - ordered by impact

1. **Retitle for this application:** 'Principal Software Engineer | Linux Kernel, Network Datapath & Zero Trust' better matches the target while remaining defensible.
2. **Rewrite the summary:** lead with 20+ years in Linux kernel networking, high-performance datapaths, drivers, L2/L3, NAT, security, Python/C/C++, and fleet-scale resilience. Keep GPU/AI as a differentiator, not the opening identity.
3. **Create a Network Security Engineering subsection:** consolidate verified firewall, tunneling, crypto/TLS, routing-protocol, packet inspection, and zero-trust work. Include exact terms only where supported.
4. **Add hands-on evidence:** show code-level contributions, unit/integration tests, profiling, debugging tools, review ownership, and measurable performance outcomes.
5. **Bridge certification experience:** describe the common work - requirements interpretation, design controls, evidence, lab/auditor coordination, remediation, and final approval - without implying FIPS/FedRAMP experience.
6. **Make collaboration explicit:** mention PRD/design review, Product Managers, customers or customer-facing teams, and mentoring, if accurate.

7. Preserve honesty: do not add Go, protocols, or certifications as standalone keywords unless Deepak has actually used them and can discuss them in depth.

Suggested evidence prompts before tailoring

Answering these determines whether the score can legitimately move into the mid-80s:

- Have you written or maintained production Go, even in a recent internal tool, service, agent, or open-source project?
- Which of BGP, OSPF, PIM, VLAN, DHCP, TLS/DTLS, QUIC, IPsec, GRE, WireGuard, L2VPN, or VRRP have you implemented, integrated, tested, or debugged?
- Have you worked with iptables/nftables, conntrack, eBPF/XDP, policy engines, stateful packet inspection, or firewall rule processing?
- Did any role involve FIPS-validated crypto modules, FedRAMP controls/evidence, Common Criteria, SOC 2, or direct security audit support?
- Can you quantify datapath performance - packets/sec, throughput, latency, CPU reduction, packet loss, or convergence time?

Final ranking conclusion

As submitted: 76/100 ATS match. The resume is technically impressive and strongly aligned to the underlying systems problem, but it does not currently prove enough of the JD's exact cloud-security networking stack to rank as an automatic top-three match. With truthful evidence for Go plus several named protocols/security controls, a tailored version could plausibly reach **84-88/100**. Without that evidence, the best strategy is a targeted referral or hiring-manager introduction that emphasizes the depth of Linux/datapath troubleshooting, architecture leadership, and AI-enabled systems work.

Method and sources

This report compares the text extracted from *Deepak_Arora_Resume_Principal_Systems_Platform_Architect(2).pdf* with *JD.txt*. Scoring uses a transparent weighted rubric based on minimum qualifications, preferred qualifications, responsibility alignment, evidence strength, exact-term coverage, and document parseability. It does not replicate Zscaler's internal ATS, recruiter judgment, interview process, or background verification.